Thea Gabrielle (Thea) Abang
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EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, Urbana-Champaign, IL **Expected Graduation:** May 2029
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science + Advertising
GPA: 3.95/4.00 | **Honors**: Chancellor's Scholar, James Scholar

Niles North High School, Skokie, IL **Graduation**: May 2025

EXPERIENCE

Grainger Engineering Undergraduate Research Champaign, IL
Events & Social Media Intern July 2026 – Present
- Author and curate weekly Engineering Undergraduate Research newsletters reaching an audience of 10,000 students.
- Design branded visual assets on Adobe Illustrator, generating social media content reaching 5,000+ viewers.

Undergraduate Research Apprenticeship Program (URAP) at Illinois Champaign, IL
Undergraduate Researcher Jan. 2026 – Apr. 2026
- Developed Qualtrics surveys and analyzed articles to research digital justice and compliance laws in advertising curriculum.

Niles Township District 219 Skokie, IL
Digital Media Intern ` Sept. 2023 – May 2025
- Grew Instagram following by 15% via Hootsuite optimization and co-created 50 graphic assets on Adobe Suite.
- Uploaded 100+ visual assets (photography, graphics) during district website migration on Finalsite.

LEADERSHIP AND ACTIVITIES

World Studios at Illinois Champaign, IL
Team Lead Sept. 2026 – Present
- Spearhead human-centered design (HCD) initiatives, guiding a cross-functional team through research, ideation, and rapid prototyping for community digital products.
- Facilitate design sprint workshops, user interviews, and iterative wireframing to refine user experiences.

Philippine Student Association at Illinois Champaign, IL
Webmaster & Tech Team Lead May 2026 – Present
- Lead front-end development and redesign of the main organization website using React, administering 40+ Google Workspace accounts.
- Direct Tech Team subgroup in architecting digital software solutions for the university community.

American Advertising Federation (AAF) at Illinois Champaign, IL
Build-It Brand Strategist Sept. 2025 – Apr. 2026
- Partnered with product manager and creative leads to formulate brand blueprints, customer journey maps, and consumer positioning strategies for *InkHeart*.
- Drafted instructional UX copy, user guidance text, and product onboarding steps to streamline customer interaction.
- Designed pop-up brand activation touchpoints and brand guidelines to establish consistent product messaging.

SKILLS & INTERESTS

Design & Strategy: Human-Centered Design (HCD), Customer Journey Mapping, Wireframing, UX Copywriting, User Research, Brand Strategy, Communication, Public Speaking
Tools & Software: Adobe Creative Suite (Illustrator, Lightroom), Canva, Hootsuite, Qualtrics, Finalsite, Google Workspace Administration
Technical Skills: React, Java, Python, SQL, HTML/CSS, C++, Javascript